MARION NELLY PAYET

PhD Candidate in Political Science – International Relations · Sciences Po Paris, CERI

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RESEARCH PROFILE

PhD Candidate in Political Science – International Relations at Sciences Po Paris (CERI), under the supervision of Carola Klöck (September 2026). Research examines how non-sovereign substate entities in centralised states construct international agency, with Reunion Island as the primary case study, using an abductive mixed-methods design (NLP, social network analysis, and qualitative fieldwork) within a rooted interpretivist framework. MRes thesis—awarded 18/20 and the highest mark of the cohort—examined Reunion Island's actorness in the governance architecture of the Southern Indian Ocean, drawing on over twenty semi-structured interviews across Parisian ministries and field institutions.

Research interests: Paradiplomacy and substate agency · Postcolonial and decolonial IR · Ocean and maritime governance · French overseas territories · Indian Ocean regionalism · Computational methods in IR · Sociology of international relations

EDUCATION

2026–

PhD in Political Science — International Relations
Sciences Po Paris, School of Research – CERI
Supervisor: Carola Klöck (Sciences Po – CERI)
Project: *"**Constructing Agency Beyond Statehood: Reunion Island and the Security–Development–Environment Nexus in the Indian Ocean**"*

2023–2025

MRes in Political Science — Major in International Relations | Cum Laude
Sciences Po Paris, School of Research
Thesis: *"Uncharted Waters? Navigating Reunion Island's Actorness in the Governance Architecture of the Southern Indian Ocean"*
Supervisor: Carola Klöck (Sciences Po – CERI)
Jury: Pr. Chiara Ruffa (president), Pr. Frédéric Ramel, Assoc. Pr. Carola Klöck
Grade: 18/20 — Highest awarded score in the cohort · Publication proposal following defence
Training: Quantitative Methods I & II; Computational Social Sciences workshop; semi-structured interviewing; archival research; thematic analysis
Class Representative
Core seminars (groupwork, both awarded highest grade):
"The Women, Peace, and Security Agenda: Multilateralism and Normativity in Complex Systems" — with Edgar Paysant & Stefania Santillo
"Of Frames and Attention: Constructing an Internationalised Intrastate Armed Conflict at the United Nations" — with Elias Brugidou & Stefania Santillo

2021–2023

"Ambition" Interdisciplinary Undergraduate Programme — Valedictorian (2023) | Highest Distinction
Université de La Réunion, Faculté de Droit et d'Économie
Selective interdisciplinary diploma combining political science, social science, and public speaking, in partnership with Sciences Po Paris
Completed four Sciences Po Paris online courses

2020–2023

Bachelor's Degree in Law (LLB) — Public Law Major | With Honours
Université de La Réunion, Faculté de Droit et d'Économie
Final-year thesis (IR): *"La matérialisation de la puissance américaine sur la scène internationale: Le processus de renouvellement de légitimité à travers l'Alliance transatlantique" — Grade: 19/20*
Supervisor: Pr. Olivier Provini (Agrégé 2025, CRJ, Université de La Réunion)
Salutatorian of the final-year class · Finalist, 'Diagonale des Juristes' public speaking competition
Class Representative

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

2025–2026

Gap Year — Mauritius
Attended the Regional SIDS Climate Finance Event
Immersion within a local NGO providing exposure to cross-border cooperation frameworks, visa regimes, and civil society-state relations in the Indian Ocean region

2024–2025

Research Intern — GENERISK Programme
Centre de Recherche Juridique (CRJ), Université de La Réunion (Dec. 2024 – Feb. 2025)
Qualitative fieldwork in public policy sociology on shark risk governance in Reunion Island
Semi-structured interviews and thematic document analysis on the 2011 shark crisis and agenda-setting dynamics

2024–2025

MRes Thesis Fieldwork
Parisian Ministries & Reunion Island (Oct. 2024 – Feb. 2025)
20+ semi-structured interviews with policymakers, regional officials, and institutional actors across Paris and Reunion Island
Examined how Reunion Island constructs and enacts international presence within constrained institutional

settings

2021–2022 **Intern — General Secretariat of the French State in Reunion Island**
Dec. 2021 – Jan. 2022
Research and drafting of briefing notes on disciplinary procedures in the civil service
Administrative support in managing civil servant mobility

PUBLICATIONS & WORKS IN PROGRESS

In preparation **Payet, M. & Klöck, C. "[Working Title] A Seat at the Table: Reunion Island's International Action in the Indian Ocean"**
In revision
Based on MRes thesis research (Sciences Po – CERI, 2025). Publication proposal made following thesis defence.

2026 **Payet, M. (2026)**
Journal du multiléralisme, ISSN 2825-6107 [en ligne]
"Penser les actions multilatérales depuis l'Océan Indien. Comment La Réunion, territoire infra-étatique français, se situe-t-elle dans les dynamiques multilatérales régionales dans l'océan Indien ?"
Available at: https://observatoire-multilateralisme.fr/publications/penser-les-actions-multilaterales-depuis-locean-indien/

2025 **Student Research Feature — APOLIMER Network (CNRS)**
apolimer.cnrs.fr (website to be updated)
"Governing the Commons from the Overseas Territories: Sketching the Contours of Reunion Island's Engagement in the International Governance of Marine Biodiversity"

ACADEMIC ACTIVITIES

April 2025 **Invited Discussant**
Sciences Po – CERI Seminar: "Environment and International Relations" (Paris & online)
Discussant for PhD presentation by Rudy Oh-Seng, in the seminar led by Carola Klöck, Sarah Tegas, and Matthew Winkler

October 2026 **Workshop — AFSP – SPRI Research Group**, "*Actualités de la recherche en sociologie politique des relations internationales*" (École des Mines Supérieure de Paris, 9 October 2026)
Presented Paper (to be published) "*A Seat at the Table: Reunion Island's International Action in the Indian Ocean*"— panel "Diplomatie, décision et trajectoires", discussant Fouad El Haddad

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

2023 **Academic Tutor — "Ambassadeur de La Réussite" Programme**
Université de La Réunion (Jan.–May 2023)
Methodological support and peer mentoring for second-year undergraduates

ASSOCIATIVE ENGAGEMENT

Jul.–Dec. 2024 **Co-Head, Partnership Pole — Sciences Po Environment**
Sciences Po Paris
Co-led the partnership strategy of Sciences Po's student environmental association, managing external institutional relations

SKILLS & LANGUAGES

Languages
- French — Native (incl. Reunionese Creole)
- English — Fluent (TOEFL 105/120, C1, May 2025)
- Spanish & Italian — A2
- Live interpretation (French/English)
- Juvenes Translatores — European Commission translation competition, selected representative (English–French, 2020)

Technical
- R / RStudio (intermediate) — statistical analysis, NLP
- QualCoder (intermediate) — qualitative data analysis
- LaTeX (beginner)
- Zotero — bibliographic management
- Microsoft / Apple / Google Suite

References and full thesis text available upon request